ERA 21

# The New Frontier & the Great Society

*1961 – 1968*

JFK · the Cold War · the Cuban Missile Crisis · LBJ's Great Society

**ESSENTIAL QUESTION**

How did two presidents confront the Cold War abroad and inequality at home?

**KEY TERMS**

The New Frontier · the space race · the Cuban Missile Crisis · the Great Society

**ALIGNED TO**

CED Topic 8.7, 8.9 · AMSCO Ch. 8.7, 8.9

'ASK NOT WHAT YOUR COUNTRY CAN DO FOR YOU…'

# A New Generation

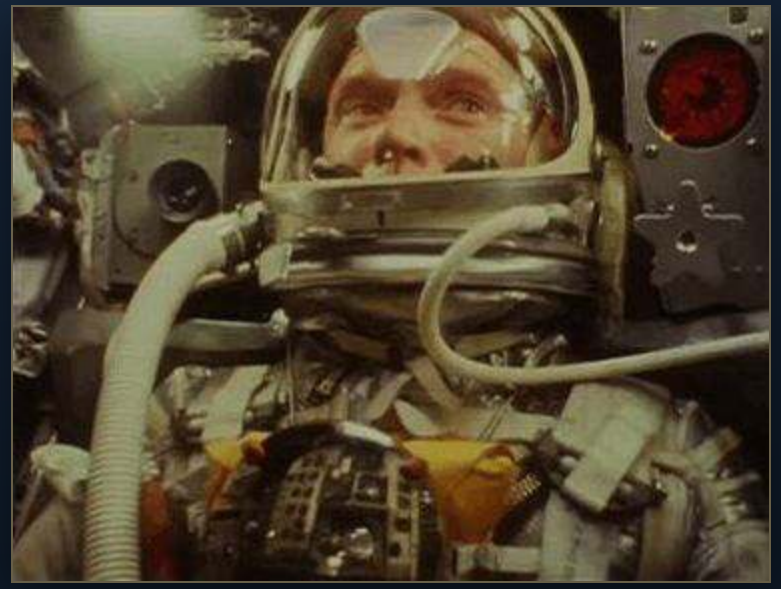
# JFK & the New Frontier



- At 43, **John F. Kennedy** brought youth and idealism to the White House.
- His '**New Frontier**' promised progress at home and abroad.
- The **Peace Corps** sent young Americans to serve around the world.

# The Space Race

- Stung by Soviet successes, Kennedy vowed to land a man on the moon.
- The **space race** became a proxy contest of the **Cold War**.
- American prestige rode on beating the Soviets to the moon.



# Cold War Flashpoints

I

## The Bay of Pigs

A failed 1961 CIA-backed invasion of **Cuba** embarrassed Kennedy.

II

## The Berlin Wall

In 1961, the Soviets walled off East Berlin—a symbol of a divided world.

III

## Rising Tensions

Each crisis pushed the superpowers closer to open conflict.

# The Cuban Missile Crisis


DAILY SKETCH

TUESDAY, OCTOBER 23, 1962 ... 3d.

CUBA SENSATIONAL MOVE BY KENNEDY

BLOCKADE!

Ultimatum to Kruschev 'Move those missiles'

Pictured in Washington—Kennedy as he said last night: We will not prematurely or unnecessarily risk the costs of world-wide nuclear war in which even the fruits of victory would be ashes in our mouth—but neither will we shrink from that risk at any time it must be faced.

PRESIDENT KENNEDY last night announced a full-scale blockade of Cuba to stop a build-up of Russian missiles there.

He said that Cuba had been turned into an offensive base able to rocket destruction into the heart of America.

Early this morning a defence spokesman said the United States is prepared to sink Soviet ships if necessary to prevent offensive weapons from reaching Cuba.

Two types

Powerful...

How to Relieve TENSE NERVOUS HEADACHES

ANADIN

Relieves Pain fast

Releases Pressure

Eases Tension

Nothing acts faster than ANADIN

© John Frost Newspapers

- In October 1962, U.S. spy planes found Soviet nuclear missiles in **Cuba**.
- Kennedy imposed a naval blockade—13 days on the brink of nuclear war.
- The Soviets withdrew the missiles; it was the **Cold War's** most dangerous moment.

November 22, 1963

# The Assassination of JFK

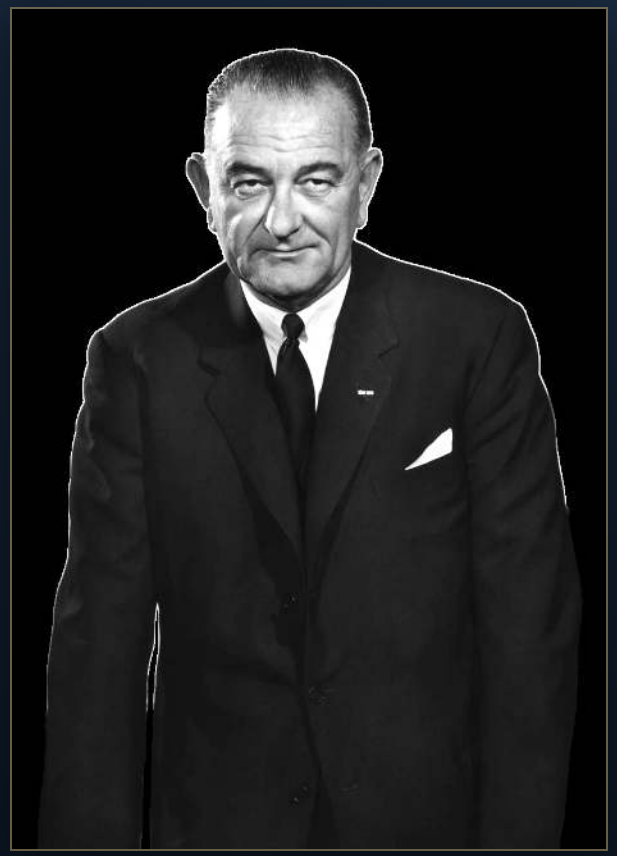
- On November 22, 1963, Kennedy was **assassinated** in Dallas.
- A stunned nation mourned as **Lyndon Johnson** was sworn in.
- LBJ would carry Kennedy's agenda—and go far beyond it.



SECTION

# The Great Society

# LBJ & the Great Society



- A master of Congress, **Johnson** launched the most ambitious reforms since the New Deal.
- He declared an unconditional '**War on Poverty**.'
- His vision of a '**Great Society**' aimed to end poverty and injustice.

A Legislative Landslide

# The Great Society

I

## War on Poverty

Head Start, job training, and the Office of Economic Opportunity.

II

## Health Care

**Medicare** for the elderly and **Medicaid** for the poor.

III

## A New America

Aid to education and the **Immigration Act of 1965**, which reopened America's doors.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

# The New Frontier & the Great Society

1. **Kennedy's New Frontier** brought youthful idealism, the **Peace Corps**, and the **space race**.
2. The **Cuban Missile Crisis** was the **Cold War**'s closest brush with nuclear war.
3. After JFK's **assassination**, **Johnson's Great Society**—**Medicare**, **Medicaid**, and the **War on Poverty**—extended the New Deal legacy.

DISCUSS & APPLY

# The New Frontier & the Great Society

AP HISTORICAL REASONING PRACTICE

**CAUSATION**

Explain how **brinkmanship** brought the world to the edge of nuclear war in 1962.

**COMPARISON**

Compare the goals of Kennedy's **New Frontier** and Johnson's **Great Society**.

**CONTINUITY & CHANGE**

How did the **Great Society** extend the legacy of the **New Deal**?

Up next — **Class 59: The Vietnam War**